after a very brief illness on the night of February 17, 1943. And nowhere else was Purshotamdas's dogged perseverance, independence, and tenacity more clearly highlighted than in the struggle to appoint C.D. Deshmukh to the post of RBI Governor. It is no exaggeration to say that but for his efforts, it is unlikely that the country would have had its first Indian Governor at the time it did.

Deshmukh has described the events leading up to Taylor's unexpected demise in his memoirs. Early in February 1943, Deshmukh had accompanied Taylor to New Delhi on the bank's work where they stayed with the Finance Member, Sir Jeremy Raisman. Deshmukh returned to Bombay a few days ahead of Taylor. On the morning Taylor arrived, he walked into Deshmukh's room and told him that he felt tired and would like to go home to rest. Deshmukh thought that Taylor looked a little under the weather but did not think it was anything serious. He visited Taylor at his residence on Carmichael Road in the evening and found him to be with a feverish cold. Taylor assured him that he would recover in a day or two. But Taylor's condition worsened the next day and his friend from Burmah Shell who was staying with him, (Taylor's wife was away in the UK), called in for consultation British medical experts who happened to be in Bombay at the time. Their diagnosis was coronary thrombosis and treatment was prescribed accordingly.[11] However, despite all care, Taylor passed away on the night of February 17. A special meeting of the RBI Committee was called the next day to condole his death. It was chaired by Deshmukh and was attended by Purshotamdas, Sir Homi Mehta, Sir Sultan Chinoy, and Sir Arthur Bruce. The cause of death as noted in the proceedings was coronary thrombosis, pneumonia, and cardiac failure. Deshmukh and other fellow officers of the RBI were the pall bearers at the funeral which was attended by prominent bankers and businessmen. Taylor's premature demise came as a terrible shock to Raisman as the two were good friends apart from being part of the ICS fraternity.

When Taylor died, the country was rife with speculation on his successor. In the ordinary course, the government should have had no difficulty in the choice of his successor for Deshmukh had been the Deputy Governor for fourteen months and had an impressive record both in the RBI and in the Civil Service. Here was a man who had all the credentials and the necessary grooming for taking over the reins from the deceased Taylor, but it soon